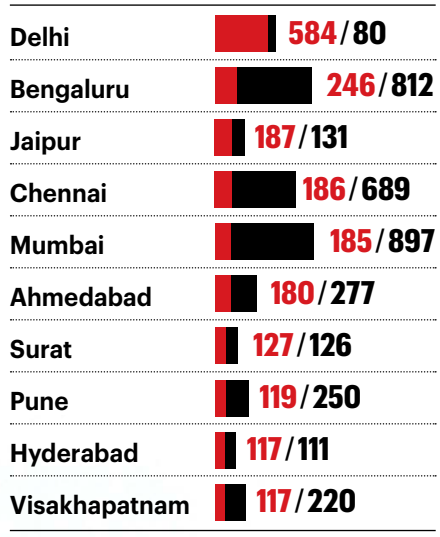
- In 10 of 12 cities, more than half of assessed footpath observations were obstructed
- Jhansi, Surat, Mumbai show the highest obstruction burden
- Even Bengaluru, the best performer in this comparison, still has 45.4 per cent of assessed footpaths obstructed

Source: Neural City, State of Indian Streets 2026. % calculated only for observations where a footpath was visible and the obstruction field was assessed. Results reflect assessed 100m units in high-footfall locations and do not represent complete citywide coverage

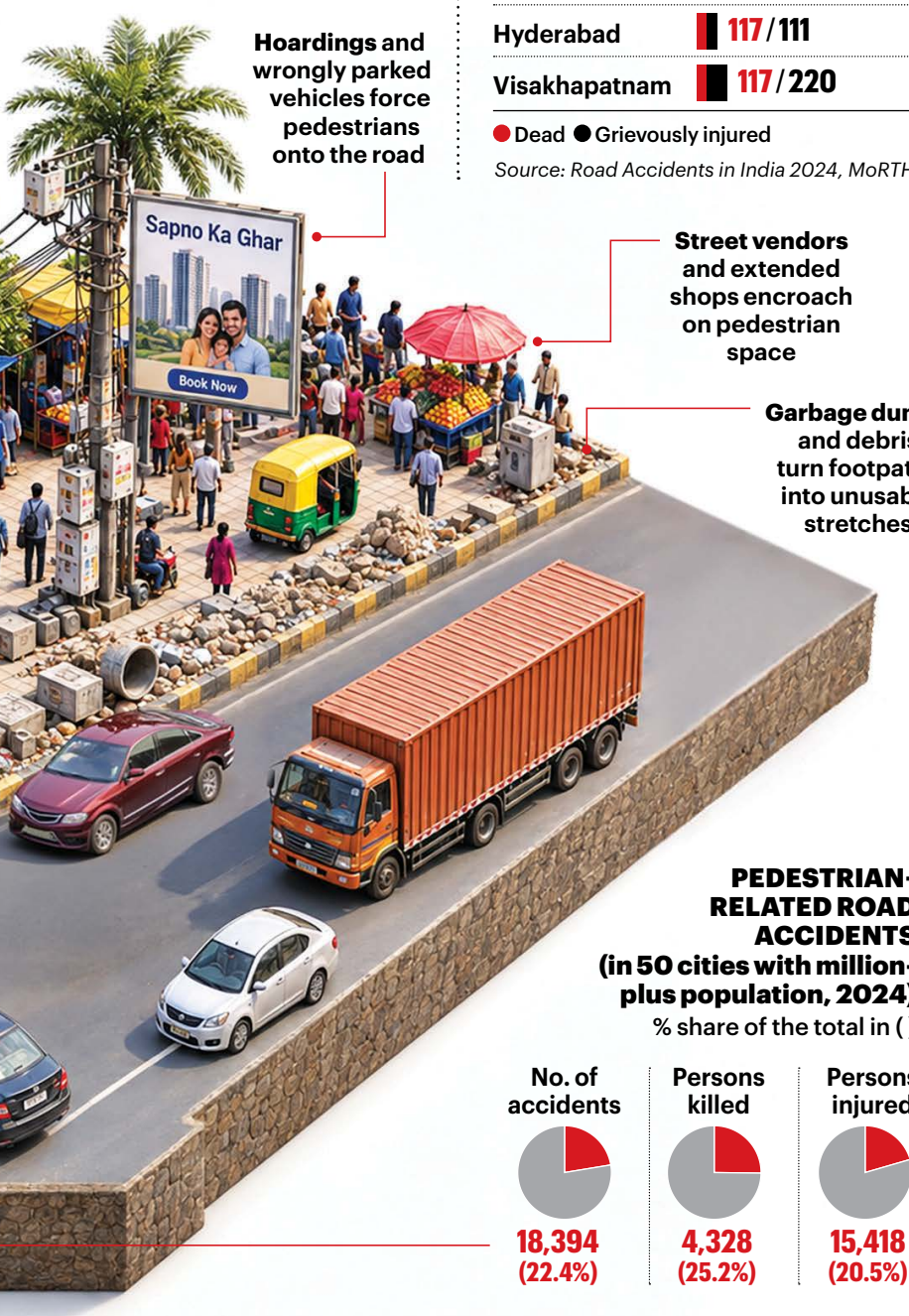
FATAL IMPACT

Delhi accounts for the highest pedestrian fatalities across India

PEDESTRIAN DEATHS/ INJURIES IN 2024 (TOP 10 CITIES)



Source: Road Accidents in India 2024, MoRTH



PEDESTRIAN-RELATED ROAD ACCIDENTS (in 50 cities with million-plus population, 2024)

% share of the total in ( )

WHAT THE SUPREME COURT SAID

- Right to walk on safe, demarcated footpaths is a fundamental right, flows from Articles 19 and 21 of the Constitution
- Pedestrian rights are 'primary', must take precedence over motorised traffic
- Every municipal corporation, urban development authority and panchayat has enforceable legal duty to build and maintain safe footpaths

WHERE CITIES HAVE GONE WRONG

- Urban street design standards exist but were never mandatory
- Road tenders prioritise carriageways, leaving footpaths to the contractors or omitting them altogether
- Even where streets are built to holistic urban designs, upkeep is rare

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

- Realise footpaths, roads and drains are part of the same system. Tenders must adhere to design guidelines, finished projects must ensure regular maintenance
- Enforce pedestrian-first approach by ensuring pavements are free of obstructions and accessible to the differently-abled
- Need quality training for the diverse groups—engineers, contractors and traffic police—who handle road systems